

Injection Site Decision Guide

Site and technique depend on route, medication, volume, age, tissue, device, and policy.

Subcutaneous - Use approved fatty-tissue sites. - Rotate sites for repeated injections. - Choose angle and skin fold for needle length and client tissue.	Intramuscular - Use an approved landmarked muscle and needle selected for client and medication. - Avoid injured, infected, scarred, or contraindicated areas. - Follow specific product guidance for site and technique.
Always - Verify route and formulation. - Use a safety-engineered needle/device. - Never recap; discard directly into sharps. - Check current school/facility policy.	

Reviewed 2026-07-13 - Source: AHRQ Patient Safety Network - <https://psnet.ahrq.gov/primer/medication-administration-errors>
Study aid only. Verify current references, instructor guidance, scope, orders, and facility policy.